

THE EQUITY EXPRESSION OF THE SILVER MINERS THESIS

The Metal Nobody Mines

Silver closed 2025 at \$70.603 an ounce. On 29 January it touched \$121.785, an all-time high, after a squeeze that drove London lease rates to roughly 39 per cent against a normal rate below one per cent. Within about thirty hours it had fallen more than 30 per cent. On 2 September it traded at \$63.87 — below where the year began, and roughly 47 per cent beneath the high.

Over the same months the companies that produce it reported the best cash flow in their histories.

Understanding why both things are true at once requires knowing something unusual about how silver reaches the market.

A reframe worth holding onto

Most commodities have a supply curve: raise the price and, after a lag, more arrives. Silver very nearly does not. Roughly seven ounces in ten are recovered as a by-product of mines sunk for lead, zinc, copper or gold, and those mines are built, expanded and closed on the economics of the other metal. The silver price is therefore an output of the market rather than an input to it. Nearly the whole burden of adjustment falls on demand and on stock, which is why the metal moves as violently as it does — and why its cost curve says almost nothing about how much of it will exist next year.

Method. External figures come from company results, industry survey data and dated market reporting, each attributed at the point of use with its date. The internal leg could not be run: the Heyokha research Wiki was unreachable from this session, so no internal page, provider issue or house view is cited below, and the sidebar reframe is the editor's construction rather than an attributed internal view. Today's topic was chosen by the reader rather than by the usual recency scoring. See *Sources and update notes*.

Consider a sawmill. It exists to cut planks, and sawdust is what falls on the floor. The mill sells the sawdust to a chipboard maker, and the money is welcome, but nobody has ever opened a sawmill in order to make sawdust. Now suppose chipboard becomes fashionable and the price of sawdust triples. What happens? Very little. The mill cannot produce sawdust without cutting planks, and it cuts planks only when planks are worth cutting. The chipboard maker may bid whatever he likes; he is bidding into a supply curve that answers to the timber market and not to him. He will get more sawdust only if somebody, somewhere, decides to build houses. This is the silver market. About seven ounces in ten arrive as sawdust, and no silver price, however extreme, persuades those mines to produce more of it.

THE STORY IN 60 SECONDS

\$63.87

Silver spot on 2 September, down 0.35 per cent on the day. That is 47 per cent below the all-time high of \$121.785 set on 29 January, and below the \$70.603 at which the metal closed 2025.
Market data, 2 September 2026.

72%

The share of world silver supply arriving as a by-product of mining other metals. Lead and zinc mines alone produced 29.4 per cent of global silver in 2024; primary silver mines produced 27.8 per cent.
Industry production data, 2024.

46.3m oz

The forecast global deficit for 2026, a sixth consecutive annual shortfall, against demand of 1,112.6 million ounces. Cumulative drawdown from above-ground stock since 2021 is 762.1 million ounces.
Silver Institute, World Silver Survey 2026.

A price that fell and a margin that did not

The January episode is worth reconstructing, because it explains both the level silver reached and the reason it did not hold. Through the second half of 2025 the freely available portion of London's silver stock had thinned: physically backed products accounted for a large majority of vaulted metal, leaving a small unencumbered float against which the market transacts. In October 2025 the cost of borrowing metal spiked, with lease rates widely reported around 39 per cent against a normal level below one per cent, and spot traded above futures — backwardation, the market's way of saying that metal today is worth more than metal later. Silver then rose 72.5 per cent from its 2025 close to peak at \$121.785 on 29 January 2026, before falling more than 30 per cent within roughly thirty hours as metal moved back into London.

What remains after the squeeze is a market with an unresolved arithmetic problem. The Silver Institute forecasts total 2026 demand of 1,112.6 million ounces against supply of 1,066.4 million, a deficit of 46.3 million ounces and the sixth in succession. Cumulatively, 762.1 million ounces have been drawn from above-ground stock since 2021. Total supply is forecast to fall 2 per cent this year, even after mine production rose 3 per cent in 2025 to 846.6 million ounces on brownfield expansion in Peru, up 7 per cent, and Chile, up 8 per cent.

The demand side is less flattering to the bull case than the deficit headline suggests. Industrial demand is forecast down 3 per cent to 657.4 million ounces. The decline is concentrated in the very application that made silver interesting: solar photovoltaics, where manufacturers have thrifted and substituted aggressively, cutting consumption by an estimated 19 per cent from 186.6 million ounces in 2025 to roughly 151 million in 2026 — faster than gains from artificial-intelligence infrastructure, vehicles and grid spending could offset. Engineers designing silver out of a cell do not put it back when the price falls.

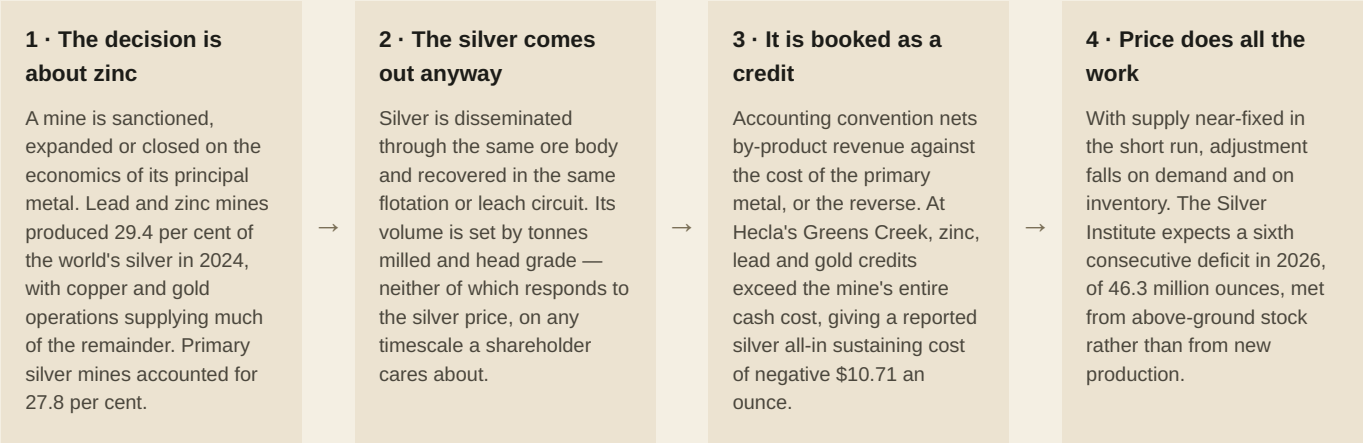
Against that, the producers have had an exceptional year. Fresnillo, the world's largest primary silver producer, tripled first-half profit to \$1.46 billion on revenue up 74.7 per cent. Coeur Mining reported record second-quarter free cash flow of \$388 million, up 165 per cent year on year. Pan American Silver generated \$344 million of attributable free cash flow and returned a record \$300 million to shareholders. Hecla Mining recorded free cash flow at all three operating mines, two of them site records. None of that required the January price. It required only that the metal remain far above the cost of getting it out — which, for reasons of geology rather than management, it comfortably is.

THE ESSENTIAL DISTINCTION

A deficit in most commodities is a signal to producers. In silver it is mostly a signal to nobody. The metal that closes the gap does not come from a mine deciding to respond; it comes from a vault. *The question is therefore not whether high prices will bring forth supply — they will not, in any quantity that matters — but how many ounces are left in London and New York, and on what terms their owners will part with them.*

MECHANISM

How an ounce of silver reaches the market



Production shares: industry data for 2024. Cost figure: Hecla Mining second-quarter 2026 results, Greens Creek silver all-in sustaining cost after by-product credits. Balance figures: Silver Institute, World Silver Survey 2026. The sequence describes the structure of supply, not a forecast; by-product share varies year to year with the relative economics of base metals.

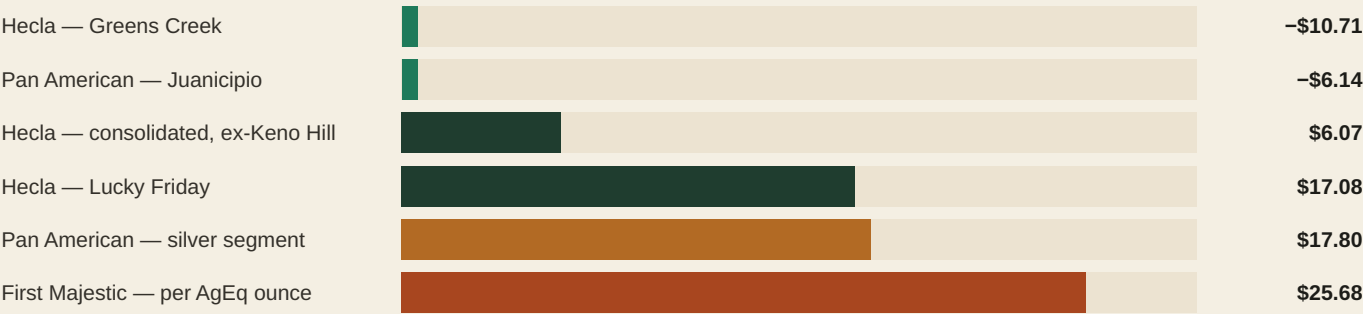


Figures as published by the companies and by the Silver Institute; no estimates or projections of the editor's own are shown.

THE COMPARISON

What it costs these companies to produce an ounce

The dispersion is the argument. Against a spot price of \$63.87, reported all-in sustaining costs across six operations run from negative \$10.71 to \$25.68 an ounce. Every one of them is profitable by a wide margin, which is why cash flow records were set across the sector this quarter. But the spread of more than \$36 an ounce between the cheapest and the dearest is not a measure of management quality. It is a measure of how much zinc, lead, copper and gold happens to sit alongside the silver — and it means the phrase “silver miner” describes six quite different businesses.



Bars are illustrative and not like-for-like. All figures are all-in sustaining costs for the second quarter of 2026 as reported by each company, but the measures differ: Hecla's and Pan American's are per silver ounce after by-product credits, while First Majestic reports per attributable payable silver-equivalent ounce, which is a different denominator. The bar scale runs from zero to \$30; the two negative figures cannot be represented on it and are drawn at nominal width with the sign shown in the value. Negative costs mean by-product credits from zinc, lead and gold exceed the mine's entire cost base. For scale, silver traded at \$63.87 on 2 September 2026 — above every bar shown.

A USEFUL MENTAL MODEL

Before buying a silver miner, work out what the company is actually selling. If by-product credits are large enough to drive the silver cost negative, the shareholder owns a zinc and lead business with a silver label. If silver is thirty per cent of revenue, the shareholder owns a gold miner. *Only a handful of listed companies offer the thing most buyers believe they are buying, and those are the ones with the highest costs and the least protection when the price turns.*

THE SHIFT

What has actually shifted

WHAT HAS CHANGED	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE IN THE DATA	WHY IT CUTS BOTH WAYS
The price	Silver at \$63.87 on 2 September, against \$121.785 on 29 January and \$70.603 at the end of 2025.	The metal is down roughly 47 per cent from its high and below where the year began, yet remains historically extreme. Bull and bear can point at the same chart and both be right.
The nature of the January move	The peak followed a squeeze in which London lease rates reached roughly 39 per cent against a norm below 1 per cent, with spot above futures. The fall exceeded 30 per cent in about thirty hours.	A squeeze price is not a clearing price. But the squeeze occurred because the free float was genuinely thin, which is a fact about the physical market rather than about speculation.
The demand mix	Industrial demand forecast down 3 per cent to 657.4 million ounces, with solar down 19 per cent to about 151 million from 186.6 million.	The fastest-growing source of demand has begun designing silver out. Thrifting is largely permanent and does not reverse when the price falls — but it also means the deficit may close without any price signal at all.
The supply response	Total supply forecast down 2 per cent in 2026, after mine production rose 3 per cent to 846.6 million ounces in 2025 on Peruvian and Chilean expansion.	Supply falling in the sixth year of deficit, after a year in which silver traded above \$120, is the inelasticity argument made in the data. It is also a reminder that the same rigidity works on the way down.
What the miners earn	Hecla's consolidated all-in sustaining cost was \$6.07 an ounce after by-product credits; Pan American's silver segment \$17.80; First Majestic's \$25.68 per silver-equivalent ounce.	Margins are extraordinary at any of these levels. But the dispersion means the sector is not one trade, and the highest-cost producer carries the most operating leverage in both directions.
Cost inflation	Fresnillo's all-in sustaining cost rose 48.3 per cent in the first half; First Majestic raised full-year guidance to \$27.69–28.77 from \$26.15–27.91 an ounce.	Rising costs consume part of the price move before it reaches shareholders. They also lift the incentive price required for genuinely new primary supply, which lengthens the deficit.

Bull and bear, stated fairly

The case for owning the producers	The case against
• The deficit is structural, not cyclical. 2026 is forecast as the sixth consecutive shortfall, at 46.3 million ounces, with 762.1 million ounces drawn from above-ground stock since 2021. Stocks are finite in a way that flow is not. • Supply cannot answer the price. Roughly 72 per cent of output is a by-product, and total supply is forecast to fall 2 per cent in 2026 — in a year following one in which silver traded above \$120. • The physical market has already seized once. Lease rates near 39 per cent in October 2025, against a norm below 1 per cent, with spot above futures. That is evidence about the float, not about sentiment. • The cash is real and already banked. Coeur's second-quarter free cash flow was \$388 million, up 165 per cent, with cash near \$1.1 billion; Pan American generated \$344 million attributable and holds \$1.8 billion; Hecla ended with \$483 million and no long-term debt outside capital leases. • Shareholders are being paid now. Fresnillo's interim dividend more than doubled to \$319.8 million from \$153.3 million, on profit that tripled to \$1.46 billion. Pan American returned a record \$300 million in the quarter. • Silver has lagged, not led. The gold/silver ratio stood at 67.9 on 2 September against roughly 46 implied at the January peak, so the metal has given back more than gold has.	• The deficit has not held the price up. Silver is down roughly 47 per cent from January and below its 2025 close of \$70.603. Five prior deficit years did not prevent that, which is evidence about how much the balance actually governs price. • January was a squeeze, not a valuation. A fall of more than 30 per cent in about thirty hours is what a thin float does in both directions. The same structure that produced \$121.785 produced \$75 the following day. • The best demand story is shrinking. Solar consumption is forecast down 19 per cent to roughly 151 million ounces, and industrial demand overall down 3 per cent. Substitution is an engineering decision and does not reverse. • The deficit is small against the market. 46.3 million ounces on demand of 1,112.6 million is about 4 per cent, and it is met from stocks still measured in hundreds of millions of ounces in London alone. • Costs are rising quickly. Fresnillo's all-in sustaining cost rose 48.3 per cent while its silver output fell 11.4 per cent; First Majestic's rose 22 per cent year on year and full-year guidance was raised. • Several silver miners are not silver miners. Silver was 30 per cent of Coeur's second-quarter revenue; Pan American reports a gold segment at \$1,984 an ounce alongside its silver segment. Much of the sector is a way of owning gold, zinc and copper.

Where the readings conflict. The comparison this format normally makes — the internal Wiki view against external reporting, with the disagreement named — cannot be made in this edition, because the Wiki was unreachable. Two external conflicts are recorded instead, and neither is resolved here. The first is a plain discrepancy in the published numbers: the Silver Institute's survey figures imply a 2026 deficit of 46.3 million ounces, while widely circulated commentary this year has described a 2026 deficit of about 215 million ounces and called it the largest on record. The two cannot both describe the same quantity, and the summaries available do not make clear whether the larger figure includes investment and exchange-traded product flows that the narrower balance excludes. A reader should treat any deficit figure quoted without its definition as unreliable, including the one on the front of this edition. The second conflict is between the metal and the equities. Silver has fallen 47 per cent from its high and sits below its 2025 close, while the companies that mine it have just reported the best quarter in their corporate histories. One of those two markets is mispricing the durability of the current margin. This edition does not attempt to say which.

What to watch from here

SIGNAL	PLAIN-ENGLISH READING	WHY IT MATTERS
London lease rates	Normal is below 1 per cent. October 2025 saw roughly 39 per cent, easing to 2–3 per cent by the middle of the first quarter of 2026.	The cleanest real-time read on whether the unencumbered float is tight. A sustained move back above a few per cent would say January conditions are returning.

SIGNAL	PLAIN-ENGLISH READING	WHY IT MATTERS
Spot against futures	Backwardation — spot trading above futures — appeared during the squeeze, inverting the normal structure.	Backwardation alongside high lease rates is the signature of physical scarcity rather than of positioning. It is the pair that matters, not either alone.
The pace of solar thrifting	Photovoltaic demand is forecast at roughly 151 million ounces in 2026, from 186.6 million in 2025.	If thrifting slows as the price falls, the demand bear case weakens sharply. If it continues near 19 per cent a year, the deficit closes itself without any price signal.
The gold/silver ratio at 67.9	Silver has lagged gold; the ratio implied at the January peak was closer to 46.	The ratio is the market's own statement about whether silver is currently being bought as a monetary asset or an industrial one. The two buyers behave very differently.
Third-quarter cost guidance	First Majestic has already raised full-year all-in sustaining cost guidance; Fresnillo's rose 48.3 per cent in the first half.	Cost inflation is the mechanism by which a high metal price fails to reach shareholders. It is also the least discussed risk in the sector at present.
Peruvian and Chilean mine supply	2025 production rose 3 per cent to 846.6 million ounces on brownfield expansion there, up 7 and 8 per cent respectively; total supply is forecast down 2 per cent in 2026.	If supply surprises to the upside, the structural scarcity argument loses the foundation it rests on. Brownfield expansion is the one lever that can respond within a couple of years.

EXPRESSION

Three postures, not one answer

Own the ounce, not the mine

Streaming and royalty companies take price exposure without the cost curve. Wheaton reported record second-quarter revenue of \$929 million, 52 per cent of it silver, at a cash operating margin of \$3,875 per gold-equivalent ounce. **The cost:** the market knows this is the safe expression and prices it accordingly, and a streamer captures little of the operating leverage that makes a high-cost producer interesting when the metal runs.

Own the low-cost by-product

Prefer mines where the silver is effectively free because zinc, lead and gold pay the bills. Hecla's Greens Creek reported an all-in sustaining cost of negative \$10.71 an ounce after credits, and all three of its operating mines generated free cash flow. **The cost:** the same credits mean the shareholder is substantially exposed to base metal prices, and the equity will not behave like silver when silver moves.

Own the operating leverage

Accept a high cost base in exchange for maximum sensitivity. First Majestic's all-in sustaining margin went from \$13.60 to \$40.27 per silver-equivalent ounce in a year. **The cost:** the arithmetic works in reverse with equal force, cost guidance has already been revised upwards, and this is precisely the posture that was destroyed in thirty hours on 29–30 January.

The companies named below are illustrative of the mechanisms described in this edition. They are NOT recommendations, and no position in any of them is expressed or implied. All figures are as reported by the companies on the dates stated.

PAAS

Pan American Silver Corp.

6.47m oz silver
Q2 2026

Attributable silver production of 6.47 million ounces came in at the high end of quarterly guidance, at a silver segment all-in sustaining cost of \$17.80 an ounce — slightly above guidance. Revenue rose 38 per cent year on year to \$1,124 million, helped by Juanicipio, acquired with MAG Silver, which contributed 1.74 million ounces at a negative \$6.14 all-in sustaining cost. Attributable free cash flow was \$344 million, cash and short-term investments \$1.8 billion, and shareholder returns a record \$300 million. The gold segment ran at \$1,984 an ounce.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the silver segment returns inside its cost guidance. Two consecutive quarters above range would make the Juanicipio credit look like a mask rather than a mix improvement.

HL

Hecla Mining Company

AISC -\$10.71/oz
Greens Creek, Q2 2026

Consolidated silver production of 4.2 million ounces rose 8 per cent on the first quarter, with a record 1.5 million ounces at Lucky Friday and nearly 2.1 million at Greens Creek. Consolidated cash costs were negative \$8.10 an ounce and all-in sustaining costs \$6.07, both after by-product credits and excluding Keno Hill; at Greens Creek the figures were negative \$17.11 and negative \$10.71. All three operating mines generated free cash flow, two at site records. The company ended with \$483 million of cash and no long-term debt outside capital leases. Full-year guidance was trimmed to 15.1–16.1 million ounces.

WATCH NEXT

Zinc and lead prices, not silver. When credits exceed the entire cost base, base metals set the reported cost of the silver and therefore the headline the market reacts to.

FRES

Fresnillo plc

22.0m oz silver
H1 2026

The world's largest primary silver producer delivered attributable first-half silver production of 22.0 million ounces, down 11.4 per cent on the same period of 2025, chiefly on the end of the Silverstream contract. All-in sustaining cost rose 48.3 per cent per equivalent ounce on higher cash costs and sustaining capital including capitalised mine development. Revenue nonetheless rose 74.7 per cent to \$3.4 billion, gross profit 130.7 per cent to \$2.4 billion, and profit tripled to \$1.46 billion. The interim dividend more than doubled to 43.4 US cents, or \$319.8 million.

WATCH NEXT

Whether cost growth moderates in the second half. A 48 per cent rise in sustaining cost against an 11 per cent fall in output is the clearest example in the sector of price masking operations.

WPM

Wheaton Precious Metals Corp.

\$929m revenue
Q2 2026

Record second-quarter revenue of \$929 million — 52 per cent silver, 46 per cent gold — produced net earnings of \$543 million and operating cash flow of \$650 million. Production was 202,200 gold-equivalent ounces, up 6 per cent, with silver output up 14.5 per cent to 6.4 million ounces. Average cash costs were \$568 per gold-equivalent ounce against \$406 a year earlier, leaving a cash operating margin of \$3,875. First-half revenue of \$1.8 billion, earnings of \$1.1 billion and operating cash flow of \$1.4 billion were all company records. A streamer owns the metal price without owning the mine's cost inflation.

WATCH NEXT

The rise in cash costs per gold-equivalent ounce. Streaming payments are contractual, so a 40 per cent increase is a statement about delivery mix rather than about inflation.

CDE

Coeur Mining, Inc.

silver 30% of revenue
Q2 2026

Record revenue of \$1.1 billion rose 27 per cent on the quarter and 126 per cent on the year, with record adjusted EBITDA of \$478 million and free cash flow of \$388 million, up 165 per cent year on year. Cash approached \$1.1 billion, close to ten times the year-earlier level. Silver production was 4.4 million ounces and contributed 30 per cent of revenue. Rochester processed a record 6.8 million tonnes. Full-year guidance is roughly 690,000 ounces of gold, 20 million ounces of silver, 45 million pounds of copper, \$2.3 billion of adjusted EBITDA and \$1.5 billion of free cash flow.

WATCH NEXT

Rochester's fourth quarter, when irrigation begins on four million tonnes placed on the Phase IIa leach pad. It is the single largest swing factor in the silver guidance.

AG

First Majestic Silver Corp.

AISC \$25.68/AgEq oz
Q2 2026

Silver production of 3.8 million ounces rose 3 per cent year on year, with gold up 2 per cent at 34,660 ounces. All-in sustaining cost per attributable payable silver-equivalent ounce was \$25.68 against \$21.02 a year earlier, and full-year guidance was raised to \$27.69–28.77 from \$26.15–27.91. The margin nonetheless widened to \$40.27 an ounce from \$13.60, because the metal price moved further than the cost base. This is the sector's purest operating leverage and its clearest illustration of why that is a double-edged property.

WATCH NEXT

A second upward revision to cost guidance. One raise is operational; two would suggest the cost base is tracking the metal price rather than the mine plan.

The bottom line

What was repriced this year was not silver's scarcity but the manner in which it was being bought. The metal closed 2025 at \$70.603, ran 72.5 per cent to \$121.785 on 29 January in a squeeze that took London lease rates to roughly 39 per cent, fell more than 30 per cent within about thirty hours, and traded at \$63.87 on 2 September — below where the year began. Across the same period the companies that produce it set records for revenue, earnings, cash flow and shareholder returns.

The evidence is mixed and should stay that way. A sixth consecutive deficit and a supply base roughly seven-tenths of which is a by-product argue that the metal cannot be produced to order at any price. A 19 per cent cut in solar consumption, and a deficit equal to about 4 per cent of annual demand met from substantial above-ground stock, argue that the shortage is being solved quietly by engineers rather than dramatically by markets. The reasonable inference concerns the equities more than the metal: at \$63.87 against reported costs running from negative \$10.71 to \$25.68 an ounce, the margin question is settled, and what remains open is cost inflation, by-product mix, and how much of the cash is returned rather than spent. The next tests are third-quarter cost guidance and whether London lease rates stay quiet.

Editorial note. This is educational commentary prepared for internal use. It is not investment advice, not a recommendation, and not a solicitation to buy or sell any security. Companies named are illustrative of the mechanisms discussed and no position in them is expressed or implied. All external figures are attributed and carry the date or period they refer to; where a figure could not be verified against a primary or dated secondary source it has been omitted rather than estimated. Internal Heyokha Wiki material would normally appear here as the named opinion of a named research provider, labelled as a view rather than a forecast; no such material appears in this edition because the Wiki could not be reached, and that failure is disclosed in the method note above and in the notes below. Where signals conflict, the conflict is stated and left unresolved rather than reconciled.

Sources and update notes

(a) Internal sources. None. The Heyokha research Wiki MCP server was not present in this session's tool set, and searches for it returned no matching tools. No internal theme page, source-summary page or provider issue was read, so no Wiki page slug, created date or *last_reviewed* date can be cited, and no research provider — 13D Research, White Box, Greed & Fear, Solid Ground, Marc Faber, HS Dent, Gary Shilling or any other — is relied upon or attributed anywhere in this edition. Every substantive claim above is external and dated.

(b) Limitation on the internal view. The standing limitation of this format is provider concentration: a Wiki theme page typically leans on two or three subscription research houses that often share a directional bias, so an internal view can appear better corroborated than it is. This edition carries the opposite limitation and it is at least as serious. Precious-metals commentary is unusually promotional, and with no internal leg there is no framework held over time against which this week's external material can be checked, and no record of what the house thought about silver before the January spike. That matters more here than in most subjects, because a large share of publicly available silver analysis is produced by bullion dealers, mining-sector promoters and specialist newsletters with a direct commercial interest in the conclusion. Where such sources have been used — principally for London lease rates, vault float and the January price sequence — the figures have been cross-checked across independent outlets, but readers should treat them with more caution than the company results and survey data, which come from primary releases. The bear case in this edition was assembled from external reporting and from tensions inside the companies' own results — principally the divergence between rising costs and falling output at Fresnillo, the 19 per cent fall in solar demand, and the size of the deficit relative to annual demand — rather than drawn from any prepared internal counter-argument.

(c) External sources. (1) Market data, 2 September 2026: silver spot \$63.87 an ounce, down 0.35 per cent on the day; gold spot \$4,336.30, up 0.18 per cent; gold/silver ratio 67.9. (2) Silver price history: all-time high of \$121.785 an ounce on 29 January 2026, a rise of 72.5 per cent from the 31 December 2025 close of \$70.603; a fall of more than 30 per cent within roughly thirty hours between 29 and 30 January to an intraday low just below \$75, settling near \$78. (3) London market structure: silver lease rates widely reported at approximately 39 per cent in October 2025 against a normal level below 1 per cent, easing to roughly 2–3 per cent by the middle of the first quarter of 2026; spot trading above futures during the episode; physically backed products accounting for the large majority of London vault inventories, leaving a limited unencumbered float. (4) Silver Institute, World Silver Survey 2026: forecast 2026 demand of 1,112.6 million ounces against supply of 1,066.4 million, a deficit of 46.3 million ounces and the sixth consecutive annual shortfall; cumulative drawdown from above-ground stock of 762.1 million ounces since 2021; total supply forecast to fall 2 per cent in 2026; 2025 mine production up 3 per cent to 846.6 million ounces, with Peru up 7 per cent and Chile up 8 per cent; industrial demand forecast down 3 per cent to 657.4 million ounces; photovoltaic demand forecast at approximately 151 million ounces in 2026 against 186.6 million in 2025, a fall of about 19 per cent. (5) Production-source shares, 2024: lead and zinc mining 29.4 per cent of global silver output, primary silver mines 27.8 per cent, with copper and gold mining supplying the remainder; approximately 70–80 per cent of global silver produced as a by-product. (6) Pan American Silver second-quarter 2026 results, 11 August 2026: attributable silver production 6.47 million ounces; silver segment all-in sustaining cost \$17.80 an ounce and gold segment \$1,984 an ounce, both slightly above guidance; attributable free cash

flow \$344 million; operating cash flow \$320 million, or \$418 million attributable; cash and short-term investments \$1.8 billion at 30 June 2026, including \$97 million for the 44 per cent Juanicipio interest; record shareholder returns of \$300 million; revenue \$1,124 million, up 38 per cent year on year; Juanicipio contributing 1.74 million silver ounces at negative \$6.14 an ounce all-in sustaining cost. (7) Hecla Mining second-quarter 2026 results: consolidated silver production 4.2 million ounces, up 8 per cent on the first quarter; Greens Creek nearly 2.1 million silver ounces and over 14,000 gold ounces, at a silver cash cost of negative \$17.11 and all-in sustaining cost of negative \$10.71 an ounce after by-product credits; Lucky Friday a record 1.5 million ounces at cash cost \$3.95 and all-in sustaining cost \$17.08; Keno Hill 625,000 ounces against 500,000 in the first quarter; consolidated cash cost negative \$8.10 and all-in sustaining cost \$6.07, after credits and excluding Keno Hill; full-year guidance revised to 15.1–16.1 million ounces from 15.1–16.5 million; \$483 million cash and no long-term debt outside capital leases; free cash flow positive at all three operating mines. (8) Fresnillo plc interim results for the six months to 30 June 2026, released 4 August 2026: attributable silver production 22.0 million ounces, down 11.4 per cent, chiefly on the end of the Silverstream contract; all-in sustaining cost up 48.3 per cent per equivalent ounce; revenue up 74.7 per cent to \$3.4 billion; gross profit up 130.7 per cent to \$2.4 billion; profit of \$1.46 billion, roughly tripled; interim dividend of 43.4 US cents a share, \$319.8 million, against \$153.3 million in the prior first half. (9) Wheaton Precious Metals second-quarter 2026 results, 6 August 2026: record revenue \$929 million, split 46 per cent gold, 52 per cent silver, 2 per cent cobalt and 0.3 per cent palladium; net earnings \$543 million; operating cash flow \$650 million; production 202,200 gold-equivalent ounces, up 6 per cent; silver production up 14.5 per cent to 6.4 million ounces; average cash costs \$568 per gold-equivalent ounce against \$406, giving a cash operating margin of \$3,875; first-half revenue \$1.8 billion, net earnings \$1.1 billion, operating cash flow \$1.4 billion, all records. (10) Coeur Mining second-quarter 2026 results, August 2026: record revenue \$1.1 billion, up 27 per cent quarter on quarter and 126 per cent year on year; record adjusted EBITDA \$478 million; free cash flow \$388 million, up 45 per cent quarter on quarter and 165 per cent year on year; cash near \$1.1 billion, close to ten times the year-earlier level; silver production 4.4 million ounces, 30 per cent of revenue; Rochester processing a record 6.8 million tonnes, with irrigation of four million tonnes on the Phase IIa leach pad due to lift fourth-quarter output; full-year guidance of approximately 690,000 gold ounces, 20 million silver ounces, 45 million pounds of copper, adjusted EBITDA of \$2.3 billion and free cash flow of \$1.5 billion. (11) First Majestic Silver second-quarter 2026 results: silver production 3.8 million ounces against 3.7 million a year earlier, up 3 per cent; gold production 34,660 ounces against 33,865, up 2 per cent; all-in sustaining cost \$25.68 per attributable payable silver-equivalent ounce against \$21.02; full-year consolidated guidance raised to \$27.69–28.77 from \$26.15–27.91; all-in sustaining margin \$40.27 an ounce against \$13.60 in the second quarter of 2025.

(d) Editorial choices in this automated run. The topic was specified by the reader rather than selected by the usual entity-recency scoring, and that changes the provenance of the choice: it was not tested against the Wiki's own view of what is currently hot. Two adjacent editions sit inside the thirty-day window — Gold Miners on 5 August and Gold on 26 August — and this edition has been written to avoid retreading them, keeping to silver's own supply structure and to the silver equities rather than to the monetary-metal argument they will already have covered. The full verified cooldown set, read directly from the HB Wiki Learning folder through mounted file access after the specified remote-devices bridge proved unavailable, is: AI Capex, Gold Miners, Grid Equipment, Oil & Gas, Software Unit Economics, Healthcare Rotation, Tanker Shipping, Uranium, Oil Chokepoint Risk, Seat-Based Software, Energy Chokepoints, Copper Smelting Bottleneck, Copper, Fiscal Dominance, China Equities, Memory Supercycle, Rare Earth Magnets, Gold, Humanoid Robots, Iran War, Coal, Grain Supply Shock, Yen Carry Trade, Power Affordability, AI Debt Financing and Stagflation, the last of these produced earlier today. Silver Miners appears nowhere in the archive. Three further judgements are disclosed. First, the Heyokha Wiki was unreachable, so this edition has no internal leg at all, as set out in paragraphs (a) and (b). Second, the bar chart mixes cost measures with different denominators — per silver ounce after by-product credits for Hecla and Pan American, per silver-equivalent ounce for First Majestic — because no common disclosure exists across the sector, and the two negative values cannot be plotted on a zero-based scale and are drawn at nominal width with their signs shown; the source note beneath states this. Third, the discrepancy between the Silver Institute's implied 46.3 million ounce deficit and the widely quoted figure of about 215 million ounces for 2026 has been reported as an unresolved conflict rather than reconciled, because the published summaries do not specify whether the larger figure incorporates investment and exchange-traded product flows excluded from the narrower balance; no attempt has been made to derive one from the other.